

PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Assignment 3: Labeling as Interpretation

Assignment

For this week's assignment, **you'll need a partner**, ideally (but not necessarily) one who is also taking PLSC 197 / SODA 110N.

The assignment goes like this:

1. Go to this site:

<https://randomwordgenerator.com/picture.php>

Enter "10" in the "Number of Pictures" box, and leave the other boxes as-is. Then click "Generate Random Pictures" to generate 10 random pictures on the page.

2. Copy and paste those 10 pictures into a document type of your choice and save it. Call this your "Pictures" file.
3. For each picture:
 - (a) **Classify** the picture into *one* of the following 12 categories: {Landscape, Plants, Animals, People, Nature, Food, Architecture, Space, Technology, Ideas, Things, Other}.
 - (b) **Label** the picture: in 1-3 words, describe what the picture depicts.
 - (c) **Annotate** the picture: Write a *single sentence* describing the picture.

It's acceptable (and may be wise) to do all of this in a spreadsheet or similar document; I've provided a [spreadsheet template](#) – with separate tabs for you and your partner – on the Github repo as an example of this.

4. Have your partner (independently, without knowing your choices) do the same thing for each of the ten pictures in your "Pictures" file.¹
5. Compare the classifications, labels, and annotations from steps (3) and (4). More specifically:
 - (a) Calculate how reliable your classifications were: For how many pictures (out of 10) do your classifications agree?

¹Note: This is why having a partner who is also enrolled in PLSC 197 / SODA 110N is useful.

- (b) Write a short paragraph about the overlap in the labels. Which photos had high agreement between you and your partner, and which were much lower? Why?
- (c) Similarly, briefly discuss whether and how the annotations were more or less similar, and why.
- (d) Finally: For the 2-3 images where your and your partner's labels are most different, come to an agreement about what the "correct" label is. Then briefly describe how those agreements were achieved: who decided which label was "correct," and by what process?

Details

Your assignment should include a separate title page with your name, the name of the course, the name of the assignment, and the date on which it was completed / submitted. It should also include a copy of your "Pictures" file containing the images you used. The body of the written assignment should be *double-spaced*, in a conventionally-sized (11 or 12 point) font. Each written part of the assignment should be as short or long as you deem necessary; a rough target might be a total of 2-3 pages, not including the "Pictures" file. You need not cite any sources for this assignment, or include references, unless you choose to.

Should you choose to do it, this assignment must be completed and submitted on or before Friday, October 9, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. ET. Submit your assignment by *creating / converting your assignment into PDF format*, and emailing it to Dr. Zorn (at zorn@psu.edu). Assignments received after the due date will not be accepted.

This assignment is worth a possible 100 points.